

AWS Administrator (4 Years Experience) - Interview Answer

"In my current role as an AWS Administrator, I am responsible for managing and maintaining the AWS cloud infrastructure. My daily activities include monitoring servers, ensuring application availability, troubleshooting issues, and supporting the development team."

My daily responsibilities include:

1. Provisioning and managing **EC2 instances**.
2. Creating and managing **S3 buckets** for application data and backups.
3. Configuring **IAM users, groups, roles, and policies** with least-privilege access.
4. Monitoring infrastructure using **CloudWatch** and setting alarms.
5. Managing **EBS volumes**, snapshots, and AMIs.
6. Launching resources using **Launch Templates** and **Auto Scaling Groups**.
7. Configuring **Elastic Load Balancers (ALB/NLB)** for high availability.
8. Managing **VPC**, subnets, route tables, Internet Gateways, and Security Groups.
9. Troubleshooting EC2, networking, storage, and permission-related issues.
10. Creating regular backups and performing disaster recovery activities.
11. Applying OS patches and security updates on Linux servers.
12. Coordinating with the DevOps and application teams during deployments.
13. Reviewing AWS billing and optimizing unused resources to reduce costs.
14. Maintaining documentation and following security best practices.

If HR asks: "What is your daily routine?"

You can answer:

"Every morning, I first check CloudWatch dashboards and alerts to verify that all production servers are healthy. Then I review support tickets, troubleshoot any EC2 or networking issues, create or modify IAM users and permissions if requested, monitor backups, check application availability, and support deployment activities. I also monitor AWS resource utilization, optimize infrastructure when needed, and coordinate with developers to resolve production issues."

If the interviewer asks: "Which AWS services have you worked on?"

Answer:

- EC2
- S3
- IAM
- VPC
- EBS
- AMI
- Auto Scaling

- Elastic Load Balancer
- CloudWatch
- Route 53
- SNS
- AWS Backup
- Systems Manager (SSM)

My Current Role and Daily Responsibilities (AWS Cloud Administrator – 4 Years)

Currently, I am working as an AWS Cloud Administrator. My primary responsibility is to manage and maintain the AWS cloud infrastructure, ensuring that applications are secure, highly available, and cost-effective.

My day-to-day responsibilities include:

- Monitoring AWS infrastructure using CloudWatch and responding to alerts.
- Launching and managing EC2 instances, including creating AMIs and snapshots for backup and recovery.
- Managing EBS volumes by attaching, resizing, and taking snapshots.
- Creating and maintaining S3 buckets with appropriate permissions, versioning, and lifecycle policies.
- Managing IAM users, groups, roles, and policies by following the principle of least privilege.
- Configuring VPC components such as subnets, route tables, Internet Gateways, NAT Gateways, and Security Groups.
- Troubleshooting connectivity issues related to EC2 instances, Security Groups, NACLs, and routing.
- Managing Load Balancers and Auto Scaling Groups to ensure application availability and scalability.
- Performing routine patching and maintenance of Linux servers.
- Monitoring CPU, memory, and disk utilization, and resolving performance issues.
- Automating repetitive administrative tasks using Bash scripts and AWS CLI.
- Coordinating with development and DevOps teams during application deployments.
- Performing regular backup verification and disaster recovery testing.
- Maintaining documentation for infrastructure changes and standard operating procedures.
- Participating in on-call support and resolving production issues based on priority and SLA.
- Optimizing AWS resources to reduce unnecessary cloud costs.
- Following security best practices, including key rotation, access control, and regular security reviews.

If the interviewer asks, "What do you do every morning?"

You can answer:

"Every morning, I first check CloudWatch dashboards and alerts to make sure all production servers are healthy. Then I verify the status of EC2 instances, review backup jobs and snapshots, check disk utilization and server health, monitor application availability behind the Load Balancer, review any overnight incidents, and respond to support tickets. If there are deployments planned, I coordinate with the DevOps and development teams. Throughout the day, I monitor infrastructure, troubleshoot issues, manage IAM permissions, and ensure the AWS environment is running smoothly."

Common follow-up questions you should be prepared for

1. How many AWS accounts do you manage?
2. How many EC2 instances are running?
3. What instance types have you worked with?
4. How do you take backups?
5. What is the difference between Security Groups and NACLs?
6. How do you troubleshoot an EC2 instance that is unreachable?
7. How do you reduce AWS costs?
8. Explain your VPC architecture.
9. What monitoring tools do you use?
10. Describe a production issue you resolved.

If you're targeting a **4-year AWS Cloud Admin** role, I can also conduct a realistic HR + Technical interview with around **100 questions and model answers** similar to what companies like TCS, Infosys, Accenture, Capgemini, Cognizant, and Wipro ask.

AWS Administrator (4 Years Experience) – Mock Interview

Interviewer: Good morning, Azeedh. Please introduce yourself.

Question 1: Tell me about yourself.

(Answer in about 2–3 minutes.)

Include:

- Your education
- Your experience
- Your current role
- Technologies you work with
- Why you're looking for a new opportunity

Your turn.

Question 2: What are your current roles and responsibilities as an AWS Administrator?

The interviewer may ask:

- What is your daily routine?
 - Which AWS services do you manage?
 - How many servers do you handle?
 - Do you support production?
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Question 3: Describe your AWS environment.

Be ready to answer:

- How many AWS accounts do you manage?
 - How many EC2 instances?
 - Which regions do you use?
 - Which operating systems?
 - Production, UAT, and Development environments?
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EC2

Question 4:

What is an EC2 instance?

Question 5:

How do you launch a new EC2 instance?

Question 6:

An EC2 instance is not reachable via SSH. How do you troubleshoot it?

Expected topics:

- Security Groups
- Network ACLs
- Route Tables
- Internet Gateway
- Public IP/Elastic IP

- SSH key
 - SSH service
 - Disk space
 - Instance status checks
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EBS

Question 7:

What is the difference between EBS and Instance Store?

Question 8:

How do you increase the root volume from 30 GB to 100 GB without downtime?

S3

Question 9:

What is Amazon S3?

Question 10:

What are S3 Storage Classes?

Question 11:

Explain Versioning and Lifecycle Policies.

Question 12:

How do you secure an S3 bucket?

IAM

Question 13:

What is IAM?

Question 14:

What is the difference between:

- IAM User

- IAM Group
- IAM Role
- IAM Policy

Question 15:

How do you provide temporary access to an EC2 instance?

VPC & Networking

Question 16:

Explain the architecture of a VPC.

Question 17:

Difference between:

- Security Group
- Network ACL

Question 18:

Public subnet vs Private subnet?

Question 19:

What is a NAT Gateway?

Question 20:

Traffic Flow

1. EC2 in the private subnet sends a request to the internet.
 2. The route table forwards the traffic to the NAT Gateway.
 3. The NAT Gateway sends the request through the Internet Gateway.
 4. The response returns through the NAT Gateway to the EC2 instance.
 5. **No inbound internet connection can directly reach the EC2 instance.**
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How to Configure a NAT Gateway

Step 1

Create a **Public Subnet**.

Step 2

Attach an **Internet Gateway (IGW)** to the VPC.

Step 3

Allocate an **Elastic IP**.

Step 4

Create the **NAT Gateway** in the Public Subnet.

Step 5

Update the **Private Subnet Route Table**:

Destination	Target
0.0.0.0/0	NAT Gateway

Real-Time Example

Suppose your company has:

- **Web Server** → Public Subnet
- **Application Server** → Private Subnet
- **Database** → Private Subnet

The application server needs to:

- Download Java updates
- Install security patches
- Connect to a payment gateway API

The Application Server uses the **NAT Gateway** for outbound internet access while remaining inaccessible from the internet.

NAT Gateway vs Internet Gateway

Feature	NAT Gateway	Internet Gateway
Purpose	Outbound internet access for private subnet	Internet access for public subnet
Location	Public Subnet	Attached to the VPC
Requires Elastic IP	Yes	No
Inbound Internet Access	No	Yes (for resources with public IPs)
Used By	Private subnet instances	Public subnet instances

Common Interview Questions

Q1: Can a NAT Gateway receive inbound internet traffic?

Answer:

No. A NAT Gateway allows **only outbound** internet access. It does not accept unsolicited inbound connections from the internet.

Q2: Where should a NAT Gateway be deployed?

Answer:

A NAT Gateway must be created in a **Public Subnet** and must have an **Elastic IP**.

Q3: Does a NAT Gateway require an Internet Gateway?

Answer:

Yes. The NAT Gateway uses the Internet Gateway to send outbound traffic to the internet.

Load Balancer & Auto Scaling

Question 21:

What is an Application Load Balancer?

Question 22:

What is Auto Scaling?

Question 23:

How do ALB and Auto Scaling work together?

Route 53

Question 24:

What is Route 53?

Question 25:

What routing policies have you used?

CloudWatch

Question 26:

How do you monitor your AWS infrastructure?

Question 27:

What metrics do you monitor?

Question 28:

How do CloudWatch Alarms work?

Linux

Question 29:

A Linux server is running out of disk space. What commands do you use?

Question 30:

Difference between:

- top
- ps
- free
- df
- du

Question 31:

How do you troubleshoot high CPU usage?

Backup & Disaster Recovery

Question 32:

What is your backup strategy?

Question 33:

How do you restore an EC2 instance?

Security

Question 34:

How do you secure an AWS environment?

Troubleshooting Scenario

Question 35:

A production website is down. What are the first five things you check?

DevOps Basics

Question 36:

Have you used:

- Git?
- Jenkins?
- Docker?
- Terraform?

If yes, explain your responsibilities.

Behavioral (HR)

Question 37:

Describe a major production issue you resolved.

Question 38:

Tell me about a time you disagreed with a teammate.

Question 39:

Why should we hire you?

Question 40:

Why are you leaving your current job?

Let's Start

Question 1: Tell me about yourself.

Please answer as you would in a real interview (2–3 minutes). I'll evaluate your answer, point out improvements, and then continue with Question 2.